- Inform patient of desired effects of medication.
- Inform patient of side effects of medication.
- Ask patient if they have any known allergies to medication
- The legally responsible party (patient, parent, family member, guardian, etc.) for patient's care has the right to refuse any medication.
- Inform responsible party of consequences of refusing medication.
- Verify that responsible party understands all of these consequences.
- Notify physician that ordered medication and document notification.
- Document refusal of medication and that responsible party understands consequences.
- Properly assess patient and tests to determine if medication is safe and appropriate.
- If deemed unsafe or inappropriate, notify ordering physician and document notification.
- Document that medication was not administered and the reason that dose was skipped.
- After medication has been administered
- Assess patient for any adverse side effects.
- Assess patient for effectiveness of medication.
- Compare patient's prior status with post medication status.
- Document patient's response to medication.
- Never document before administration of medicine.

Do's and Don'ts

- Do not give out dated or expired medication
- Do not give medication beyond stop date
- Do not administer medication that have changed colour or consistency
- Administer medication that are taken only from properly labeled or prescribed container

CONCLUSION

Considering the needs of the nursing students, the subject matter is prescribed very briefly to understand the essence of pharmacology and know their responsibilities while practicing as a nurse at all settings. Drugs may be prescribed to promote healing, cure disease control or slow progression of disease, prevent disease, decrease risk of complications, increase comfort level, reduce excessive activity in the body. Therefore it's the duty of the nurses to flourish with adequate knowledge, skill and attitude among the health care professionals to make our profession in flying colours.

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